

Southern Community Orthopaedic Triage Service (SCOTS)



STEP OUT WITH CONFIDENCE!

Who we are:

SCOTS as a service is part of the Orthopaedic Outpatient Department Services and is designed to help patients with musculoskeletal conditions (e.g concerns with your joints, muscles, other soft tissues) access the right care, at the right time, in the right place. We provide assessment and guidance for people experiencing these problems, ensuring that treatment pathways are clear, appropriate, and effective.

Why SCOTS exists:

Clinical practice guidelines indicate that the gold standard of management for many musculoskeletal/orthopedic conditions (including Osteoarthritis) is a comprehensive targeted, and time appropriate trial of non surgical strategies. SCOTS ensures you have access to these strategies and can trial them appropriately for your condition.

Our role:

SCOTS provides assessment to determine the most appropriate pathway for you. We work closely with GPs, community providers, and Orthopaedic teams to support this.

Our objectives:

- 1) To make sure you receive the right treatment, at the right time, for the best possible outcome.
- 2) Ensure you have access to a comprehensive trial of rehabilitation and education programs to consider their effectiveness.
- 3) Support you to step out in confidence by providing strategies you can use to manage your condition by yourself where appropriate.

What will happen at my appointment?

We will:

- Listen to your concerns and goals
- Assess your condition
- Review any previous treatment
- Discuss your diagnosis and options

Together, we will agree on a clear plan forward.

What if I have already trialed Physiotherapy?

That is helpful information.

We will look at:

- What type of treatment you have had
- How long you tried it for
- Whether it was targeted and progressive
- Whether it was specifically tailored to your problem

Sometimes a more structured approach can still lead to improvement.

How can I prepare for the assessment?

- Bring any relevant scan reports or letters
- Wear comfortable clothing for assessment
- Be ready to discuss how your condition affects your daily life



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What happens after the assessment?

Depending on your assessment, we may:

- Start or adjust a rehabilitation plan
- Invite you to an education program
- Discharge you with advice
- Refer you for further investigations
- Refer you for a surgical opinion

If a trial of treatment is recommended, we will set a clear timeframe and review your progress.

After I have completed the program what is next?

We will provide a review assessment after you have completed your treatment to consider your progress and agree on the best plan moving forward.

If you have any questions before seeing us, please speak with your GP or the referring clinician. We look forward to supporting you. - SCOTS Team.

Our Service Locations:

Assessment Clinics:

- Te Kaika Wellbeing Hub
- Zingari Richmond Football Club

Rehab program sites:

- Zingari Richmond Football Club Gym

Education program sites:

- Nutrition Clinic- Otago University
- Chatsford Retirement Village Events Centre

Contact us:

Contact details will be made available after your first appointment with us.

Helpful Links:

1. Arthritis New Zealand: <https://www.arthritis.org.nz/>
2. Otago University Pharmacy Clinic: <https://www.otago.ac.nz/pharmacy-clinic>

